



HOW CAMPAIGNS WORK

A campaign for this age is a string of friendly episodes. Each session should have a clear helper, a magical place, one puzzle, and one warm ending.



Campaign rhythm: arrive, discover, help, celebrate.

Length: 20–40 minutes per adventure. Stop while adventurers still want more.

- Start with a read-aloud box.
- Ask one choice at a time.
- Use three scenes: arrive, discover, help.
- End with a sticker, drawing, or named promise.

Minute	What to do
0–5	Read the hook and ask what the heroes notice.
5–15	Meet a creature or obstacle with a feeling.
15–30	Try two or three adventurer ideas, rolling only for exciting moments.
End	Name the friend helped and draw one treasure.



ADVENTURE 1: THE LOST MOON-BELL

Read aloud: “The moon is stuck in the loch like a silver coin. A young kelpie foal stamps at the water and tries not to cry.”

- Meet the nervous kelpie foal.
- Search reeds, stones, or bubbles for clues.
- Return the bell by singing, wading, or asking the loch nicely.

Idea	Stat
Step onto slippery stones	Agility
Comfort the foal	Wis
Hold the rope in a gust	Strength
Notice bubbles making an arrow	Wis
Promise to bring the bell back	Luck

- The kelpie foal carries everyone one careful step across the shallows.
- The loch hums the first note of the bedtime song.
- A wet map reveals the next path when it dries.

Scenes

Roll moments

Ending choices

ADVENTURE 2: THE GRUMPY BRIDGE

Read aloud: “The bridge folds its stony arms. ‘No crossing,’ it rumbles, ‘unless someone remembers how to laugh politely.’”

Reward: the bridge teaches the party the safe stepping rhythm: clap, step, clap, step.

- Moss hides a carved smiling face.
- The bridge remembers adventurers who thanked it long ago.
- A silver fox waits on the other side with dry socks.

- The bridge is not mean; it is embarrassed because moss covers its carvings.
- Adventurers can clean, joke, sing, draw, or ask what happened.
- A wobble makes the bridge sneeze pebbles, not hurt anyone.

Extra clues



ADVENTURE 3: THE THISTLE CROWN

Read aloud: “A tiny sprite wears a crown too big for its head. It declares itself King of All Paths, then whispers, ‘Do I look brave?’”

The sprite is scared of guarding the path alone. It needs help making a promise flag.

- Make a tiny flag.
 - Share a brave story.
 - Ask another creature to visit.
 - Let the sprite choose a less lonely job.
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- The crown slips over the sprite’s eyes.
 - The path grows extra thistles, but they smell like jam.
 - The sprite declares a snack break and forgets to be bossy.

What is really happening?

Good solutions

If the heroes wobble

MINI CAMPAIGN TRACKER

Session	Bell or promise	Friend made	Drawing space
1	Moon-Bell		
2	Bridge rhythm		
3	Thistle Crown promise		
Finale	Bedtime song returns		

Finale idea: every friend returns and adds one sound to the bedtime song: splash, clap, rustle, giggle, bell.

If time is short

Run only the hook, one helpful creature, and the warm ending.

If adventurers want more

Let them draw the new friend, then turn the drawing into the next adventure hook.





CAMPAIGN 2: THE RED BANNER ROAD

Premise: Redcloak agents from the Dominion of Albion have crossed the southern road to tax villages, measure fairy hills, and seize mythral relics.

Six-session arc

Session	Episode	Main pressure
1	Taxes at Kettleford Bridge	Redcloak patrol demands coin and maps.
2	The Stolen Standing Stone	Albion surveyors move a fairy boundary marker.
3	Warg with the Iron Collar	Free a border warg from command magic.
4	Clan Moot under Rain	Unite rival clans without starting a feud.
5	Raid on the Red Supply Cart	Rescue prisoners, charms, and stolen maps.
6	The Banner That Lied	Break an enchanted conquest banner.

Villain note

The Dominion of Albion is a fantasy imperial faction. Do not say every southerner is evil; make the villains the army, greedy nobles, cursed banners, and officials trying to erase Alba's names.

Scene tools

Redcloak patrol

2 guards, 1 tax-mage, one nervous local guide.

Moral choice

Rescue prisoners now, or steal the map that saves three villages later?

Magic problem

The banner makes locals forget their own hill names.

Reward

Clan reputation, a freed warg ally, or a red-sealed map.

Recurring place

Kettleford Bridge changes each visit: tax chain, rumor crowd, warg tracks, then banner shadow.

Boss prep

Redcloak Captain carries orders, fear, and a banner tassel that points to the final true-name ritual.

RED BANNER ROAD: SESSION PACKETS

1. Taxes at Kettleford Bridge

Read aloud: Red cloaks block the bridge while a nervous goat chews their map. Goal: protect villagers without starting a battle. Key rolls: Wis to calm the crowd, Int to spot false tax marks, Strength to hold the bridge chain. Reward: bridge oath token.

2. Stolen Standing Stone

Surveyors moved a fairy border stone. Goal: learn its true name and roll it home. Wobble: the wrong hill wakes first. Reward: Rowan Compact favour.

3. Iron-Collar Warg

A warg attacks because a collar commands it. Goal: break the collar, not the wolf. Clues: red wax seal, rubbed fur, sad eyes. Reward: possible earned mount/ally.

4. Clan Moot in Rain

Two clans accuse each other of helping Albion. Goal: prove the tax-mage forged both letters. Use truth-song, guest-right, and one brave speech.

5. Red Supply Cart

Sneak, bargain, or distract to free prisoners and stolen charms. Add a three-bell countdown before patrol returns.

6. Banner That Lied

Finale: the conquest banner renames hills. Break it with true names gathered from every prior session. Boss phase: Redcloak Captain loses command when locals sing.

Recurring NPC: Nessa Toll-Keeper

Starts afraid of Redcloaks; becomes brave if the heroes protect her bridge bell. She can hide messages in toll receipts.

Evidence trail

Each session yields one proof: false tax seal, moved boundary chip, broken collar rune, forged clan letter, prisoner list, banner true name.

Escalation clock

After every session, mark one red wax dot. At three dots, patrols double. At six, the conquest banner reaches Kettleford.

Finale checklist

To beat the banner: gather three true hill names, cut the red wax tassel, and have a local speak the land oath aloud.

CAMPAIGN 3: LONGSHIPS IN THE MIST

Premise: Norse-style sea raiders, traders, and oath-ghosts arrive from the northern isles. Some want trade, some want plunder, and some are dead but still rowing.

Harbor Hook

A longship appears with no crew, one blue lantern, and a shield carved with a broken oath.

Friendly Viking

Jorunn Wave-Smith wants peace, trade, and help laying her ancestor draugr to rest.

Raider Threat

Skull-Sail Rurik steals bells because he thinks they command fairy weather.

Sea Magic

Runes, whale-road maps, storm knots, salt charms, oath rings, and ghost anchors.

Episodes

- The Empty Longship
- Market Day under Axes
- Draugr in the Sea Cave
- The Storm-Knot Duel
- Feast-right at the Clan Hall
- The Oath-Raiders Rest

Sea encounters

1	Fog hides a friendly trader and a hostile raider.
2	A seal-spirit demands the party judge an oath.
3	Draugr row beneath the boat at midnight.
4	A storm knot must be untied with song.

Harbor clock

At three bells, market closes. At six bells, raiders choose a target. At nine, the tide opens the sea cave.

Peace route

A feast, repaired sail, and returned oath-ring can turn raiders into rivals instead of enemies.

Treasure route

Each episode gives one ship-token clue: lantern, shield, ring, cup, knot, final oath.

Draugr route

If ignored, the ghost crew grows louder and colder; if honored, they guide the party through fog.

LONGSHIPS IN THE MIST: SESSION PACKETS

1. Empty Longship

The ship arrives crewless with one blue lantern. Search cargo, comfort frightened harbor folk, learn the shield oath.

2. Market Day Under Axes

Traders and raiders argue. Keep guest-right, separate Skull-Sail Rurik from peaceful Jorunn, and save the bell stall.

3. Draugr Sea Cave

Return a stolen ship-token while tide rises. Rolls: Agility on slick rocks, Wis for oath grief, Luck for storm timing.

4. Storm-Knot Duel

Untie weather knots by song, riddle, and courage. Wobble: rain falls upward for one scene.

5. Feast-right Hall

Win peace through food, story, and one fair challenge. No fighting under the roof once bread is shared.

6. Oath-Raiders Rest

Finale: complete the oath carved on the shield so the dead rowers can sleep and the living can trade.

Recurring NPC: Jorunn Wave-Smith

Friendly Norse smith-trader. She offers repairs, sea lore, and a moral reminder that not every longship comes to raid.

Oath clues

Broken shield, blue lantern, missing ring, drowned map, feast cup, and the final carved promise all point to the same betrayed voyage.

Sea travel rhythm

Each voyage scene gets weather, sound, choice: fog + oars + steer toward harbor or cave; storm + gulls + cut sail or sing.

Finale checklist

Return the ship-token, feed the living crew under guest-right, speak the shield oath, and let the draugr choose rest.

CAMPAIGN 4: THE BARBARIAN QUEEN OF THE NORTH

Premise: The storm-clans beyond the high passes are called barbarians by outsiders, but they have laws, poets, healers, and old reasons to distrust lowland kings.

Key NPCs

Name	Role	What they want
Queen Maev Stormbraid	Clan war-leader	Return of a stolen clan cauldron.
Old Duthac	Oath poet	Someone to remember the true story.
Bran of the Broken Axe	Hot-headed champion	A fair duel, not a massacre.
Eithne Rowan-Seer	Seer	The Thorn Court kept out of clan dreams.

Adventure structure

- Prove guest-right by sharing food.
- Solve a stolen-cauldron mystery.
- Stop a duel using truth, not force.
- Enter the storm cairn and face an oath monster.
- Choose whether clans join Alba against the Dominion.

Clan customs

Guest-right	Food shared means no one may attack under that roof.
Truth-song	A bard may settle disputes by singing the true version.
Fair challenge	A duel can be riddle, wrestling, race, poem, or shield-hold.

Respect scene

Before each roll, ask: do you speak as guest, challenger, witness, or helper? The answer changes the stat.

Cauldron clues

Ash on red wax, wagon tracks, missing feast song, and a frightened page point to Albion theft.

Duel variants

Run Bran's duel as race, shield-hold, riddle, wrestling, poem, or carrying water through wind.

Alliance reward

If won respectfully, the party earns storm-clan shelter and a cairn goat companion hook.

BARBARIAN QUEEN: SESSION PACKETS

1. Guest-right Test

The heroes must share food and answer a challenge without insulting the storm-clans. Reward: safe fire and one honest question.

2. Stolen Cauldron

Investigate tracks, lies, and red wax. Twist: Albion agents stole the cauldron to stop clan feasts.

3. Broken Axe Duel

Bran demands a duel. Make it race, riddle, shield-hold, poem, or wrestling with non-lethal stakes.

4. Storm Cairn

Enter the cairn, face an oath monster, and return the queen's ancestor story. Use thunder as a countdown.

5. Queen's Choice

Convince Maev Stormbraid to join Alba against the Dominion by proving respect, truth, and returned treasure.

6. Pass of Two Banners

Finale: storm-clans and lowland clans stand together while the Red Banner road closes. Earn clan cloak or cairn goat companion.

Recurring NPC: Old Duthac

Oath poet who never lies but tells truths in riddles. He can turn a failed argument into a fair challenge.

Clan respect track

Gain respect for shared food, fair challenge, returned cauldron, remembered ancestor, and refusing Redcloak lies. Lose it for insults.

Storm signs

Thunder answers broken oaths. Lightning points at hidden red wax. Rain stops when someone tells the true story.

Finale checklist

Return the cauldron, settle Bran without humiliation, name the ancestor, and ask Maev for alliance as an equal.

ENCOUNTER MAPS AND TRAVEL PROCEDURES

Travel turn

- Pick route: road, moor, loch, forest, coast, old Roman road, fairy path.
- Choose pace: careful, normal, urgent.
- Roll one travel event if the route is dangerous.
- Mark food, weather, one rumor, and one map change.

Map symbols

Castle	law, soldiers, taxes
Cairn	oaths, ghosts, memory
Loch	water magic, kelpies, secrets
Longship	raids, trade, oaths

Travel events

1	Redcloak patrol measuring land.
2	Norse trader offers a cursed bargain.
3	Barbarian scouts test guest-right.
4	Fairy ring moves the road.
5	Monster sign: claw marks, cold fog, iron feathers.
6	Helpful local: shepherd, fisher, brownie, corbie messenger.

After travel

- Ask one player to mark the route on the map.
- Ask another to name a rumor learned on the road.
- If a companion helped, advance its bond if the table cared for it.
- Turn one travel event into tomorrow's hook.

Route costs

Careful	safe clue, slower clock.
Normal	one event.
Urgent	arrive fast, start with mud/noise/tired companion.